

# Grant Opportunities for Lantern OS

Normie Report for Shelby | May 30, 2026

## The Big Picture

We found **real grant money** that could fund Lantern OS. Some deadlines are soon. None of them require giving away ownership of the company. This report lists what we found, why each one fits, and exactly what to do next.

## Grant 1: Survival and Flourishing Fund (SFF) — HSEE Round

**What it is:** A philanthropy run by Jaan Tallinn (cofounded Skype). They give away \$20-40 million per year to projects that help humans thrive alongside AI.

**Why Lantern fits:** They have a theme round called 'Human Self-Enhancement and Empowerment' (HSEE). It funds tools that help humans stay capable and empowered as AI advances. Lantern OS is literally a local-first tool that keeps humans organized and in control of their own files and workflows.

**Money:** \$2-4 million total in this round. Individual grants vary.

**Deadline:** July 8, 2026 at 11:59 PM PT

**Type:** You can apply as a charity or for-profit. Funding can be non-dilutive (they don't take equity).

**Real talk:** This is the best fit we found. The description basically reads like Lantern's mission statement.

## Grant 2: Survival and Flourishing Fund (SFF) — Main Round

**What it is:** The same fund's general grant round. Three tracks:

- Main Track: Broad long-term survival and flourishing of sentient life
- Freedom Track: Individual freedom and autonomy
- Fairness Track: Fair distribution of benefits and risks

**Why Lantern fits:** Local-first = user owns their data = freedom track fit. Safety hooks and evidence boundaries = survival track fit. Open source tooling for regular people = fairness track fit.

**Money:** \$14-28 million total across all three tracks.

**Deadline:** Rolling application open now.

**Real talk:** Apply here too even if you apply to the HSEE round. They run independently.

### Grant 3: Mozilla Open Source Support (MOSS) — Foundational Technology

**What it is:** Mozilla (the nonprofit behind Firefox) gives money to open source projects that make the internet healthier.

**Why Lantern fits:** Lantern OS is open source. It keeps data local instead of feeding the cloud-everything model. It empowers users to control their own information.

**Money:** \$10,000 to \$250,000 per award.

**Deadline:** Rolling / no fixed deadline, but apply sooner for faster review.

**Catch:** You need a 'Mozilla champion' -- someone who works at or is connected to Mozilla who will vouch for the project.

**Real talk:** Smaller money than SFF, but easier process and no equity strings.

#### Grant 4: NSF SBIR / America's Seed Fund

**What it is:** The U.S. government gives up to ~\$305,000 to small businesses doing deep tech R&D.; No equity taken.

**Why Lantern fits:** AI + local-first computing qualifies as deep tech. They specifically have AI topics open.

**Money:** Phase I = up to ~\$305,000. Phase II = up to ~\$2 million.

**Deadline:** New solicitations opened June 2, 2026. Project pitches accepted now.

**Catch:** Must be a U.S. small business. At least 50% owned by U.S. citizens or permanent residents. Requires a 'Project Pitch' first.

**Real talk:** More paperwork than the others, but it's government money with no strings attached.

## Quick Comparison

| Grant        | Money         | Deadline     | Fit       | Difficulty |
|--------------|---------------|--------------|-----------|------------|
| SFF HSEE     | \$2-4M pool   | July 8, 2026 | Excellent | Medium     |
| SFF Main     | \$14-28M pool | Rolling      | Very Good | Medium     |
| Mozilla MOSS | \$10K-\$250K  | Rolling      | Good      | Easy*      |
| NSF SBIR     | Up to \$305K  | Open now     | Good      | High       |

\*Easy if you find a Mozilla champion. Otherwise, harder.

### **This Week (Before June 6)**

1. **Pick your top 2** -- Recommended: SFF HSEE + SFF Main Round. Best fit, most money, real deadline soon.
2. **Read the SFF HSEE application page** -- URL: [survivalandflourishing.fund/hsee-application](https://survivalandflourishing.fund/hsee-application) | Time: 30 min
3. **Draft a one-paragraph project summary** -- Use plain language. This paragraph will be reused across all applications.

### **Next Two Weeks (Before June 20)**

4. **Apply to SFF HSEE round** -- Step 1: Rolling Application. Step 2: HSEE Supplemental. Deadline: July 8, 2026.
5. **Apply to SFF Main Round** -- Same rolling application. Pick the track that feels most natural.
6. **Find a Mozilla champion** -- Ask in your network. Check LinkedIn. If no lead in 2 weeks, park this and focus on SFF.

### **This Month (Before June 30)**

7. **Decide on NSF SBIR** -- If you are a U.S. small business and have bandwidth for government paperwork, draft a Project Pitch.
8. **Collect evidence** -- Screenshot the WOW-FACTOR report. Link to the GitHub repo. List any users, pilots, or demos.

## What You Need to Have Ready

| Item                          | Status           | Needed For       |
|-------------------------------|------------------|------------------|
| One-paragraph project summary | Need to draft    | All applications |
| GitHub repo link              | Have it          | All applications |
| Evidence of use               | Need to document | SFF, MOSS        |
| Financial need statement      | Need to draft    | All applications |
| U.S. business status          | Check            | NSF only         |



## The Bottom Line

**There is real money available that matches what Lantern OS is building.**

The best opportunities are SFF HSEE (July 8 deadline, \$2-4M pool, perfect mission fit) and SFF Main (\$14-28M pool, rolling, also fits well). Mozilla MOSS is smaller but easy. NSF SBIR is more paperwork.

**No revenue claims needed. No investor pitches. Just explain what you built, why it matters, and what you need money for.**

## Contact Info for Questions

SFF: [sff-contact@googlegroups.com](mailto:sff-contact@googlegroups.com)

Mozilla MOSS: [mozilla.fluxx.io/apply/MOSS](https://mozilla.fluxx.io/apply/MOSS)

NSF SBIR: [seedfund@nsf.gov](mailto:seedfund@nsf.gov)

## Shelby's Checklist

| Done                     | Action                                     |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Read this whole report                     |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Pick top 2 grants to pursue                |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Draft one-paragraph project summary        |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Apply to SFF HSEE round (deadline: July 8) |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Apply to SFF Main round                    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Look for Mozilla champion connection       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Decide yes/no on NSF SBIR                  |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Document any user/pilot evidence           |